

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

– which does and will happen – or taking your eye off the ball, it will pay you dividends in both a practical sense and a mindset sense. It's all too common to engage enthusiastically while we feel that we're smashing it, but to panic and avoid when we feel like we've taken a wrong turn. This is a challenge that you are absolutely equal to, and one that will help you to even out your feelings about money in the long term.

In these moments, remember that acts of overspending or budgeting fails don't define you – they're just part of being human. You can return to Step One and some of the self-forgiveness practice if you need or want to, but the main thing is to stay engaged. Check your bank balance even after a bank holiday weekend when your pockets are stuffed with receipts, and you feel that swirling anxiety begin to grow. Things may not be as bad as you think they are, and even if they are, now is the time to address and put strategies into place to cope and compensate.

As time goes on, your relationship with money will grow more resilient to these challenges, and you'll find it easier to practice exposure and engagement without the accompanying stress – you just have to make it a habit, and not allow slip ups to derail your progress or your mindset.